1909–1966



“PHYSICS IS MY LINE. I KNOW I SHALL DO GREAT THINGS HERE.”

Homi Bhabha was a nuclear physicist who helped establish India’s nuclear energy programme. He came to believe that India needed nuclear energy to develop its industries and cities, and his efforts resulted in the establishment of research institutions like the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research in 1945 and the Indian Atomic Energy Commission in 1948. The Department of Atomic Energy was created in 1954, and Bhabha was appointed its secretary. By 1956, India had its first nuclear reactor (which also happened to be Asia’s first). A visionary scientist, Bhabha also held a number of high-profile appointments, including, notably, president of the United Nations Conference on the Peaceful Uses of Atomic Energy in 1955.